

Typhoon Preparedness Guide

Understanding Disasters

A disaster is a sudden, catastrophic event that causes significant disruption, destruction, and potential loss of life and property. Disasters can be natural, such as earthquakes, floods, volcanic eruptions, and typhoons, or man-made, like industrial accidents and environmental hazards. In the Philippines, typhoons are among the most common and destructive natural disasters due to the country's geographical location in the Pacific typhoon belt.

Being prepared for disasters is crucial in minimizing their impact on lives and property. Disaster preparedness involves planning, organizing resources, educating communities, and taking preventive measures before, during, and after an emergency.

This guide focuses specifically on typhoon preparedness and is designed to help individuals and families take the right actions to stay safe and resilient in the face of storms.

Before a Typhoon

- Monitor weather updates and typhoon warnings from PAGASA.
- Secure your home by reinforcing windows and doors.
- Trim trees and branches that could fall on your house.
- Prepare an emergency kit with food, water, medicine, and important documents.
- Know your evacuation plan and routes.
- Charge your phones and power banks.
- Store enough food and water for at least 3 days.
- Ensure pets are in a safe place and have adequate food and water.
- Inform family members and neighbors about your preparedness plans.
- Remove or secure outdoor items that may become projectiles.
- Back up important digital files and documents.
- Identify the nearest emergency shelter and know how to get there safely.
- Practice your family's emergency drill to ensure everyone knows what to do.
- Keep cash on hand in case ATMs are unavailable.
- Stock up on batteries, flashlights, and a battery-operated radio.

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During a Typhoon

- Stay indoors and away from windows.
- Turn off the main power if there is flooding or risk of electrical damage.
- Keep monitoring emergency broadcasts.
- If evacuation is ordered, follow instructions immediately.
- Move to the strongest part of your house if unable to evacuate.
- Keep your emergency kit with you at all times.
- Avoid using the phone except for emergencies to keep lines open.
- Stay calm and reassure family members, especially children.
- Avoid lighting candles during power outages-use flashlights instead.
- Keep doors and windows securely closed to prevent wind damage.
- Stay alert for emergency alerts and updates on changing conditions.

After a Typhoon

- Check for injuries and provide first aid if needed.
- Be cautious of damaged structures, fallen power lines, and flooding.
- Do not wade through floodwaters as they may be contaminated.
- Check your water and food supplies for contamination.
- Report damaged utility lines to authorities.
- Help neighbors, especially the elderly and those with disabilities.
- Document property damage for insurance claims.
- Clean and disinfect items that got wet to prevent mold and infection.
- Stay informed on further weather updates and safety instructions.
- Avoid using tap water until local authorities confirm it is safe.
- Wear protective clothing and gloves when cleaning debris.
- Watch out for animals or insects that may have entered your home.
- Dispose of spoiled food properly and sanitize food preparation areas.
- Review your emergency plan and restock your supplies for future preparedness.

Additional Resources

- PAGASA (Philippine Atmospheric, Geophysical and Astronomical Services Administration):

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<https://www.pagasa.dost.gov.ph>

- National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council (NDRRMC): <https://ndrrmc.gov.ph>
- Philippine Red Cross: <https://redcross.org.ph>
- Follow local government social media pages for real-time updates and alerts.
- Attend community disaster preparedness training sessions if available.

Stay safe and prepared. Your safety starts with knowledge and action.